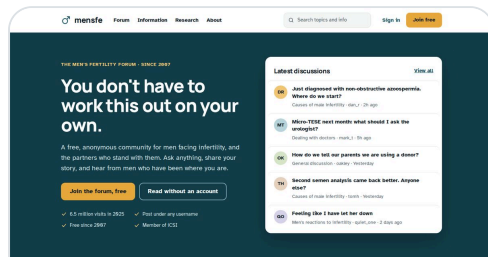


Four directions for the Mensfe forum

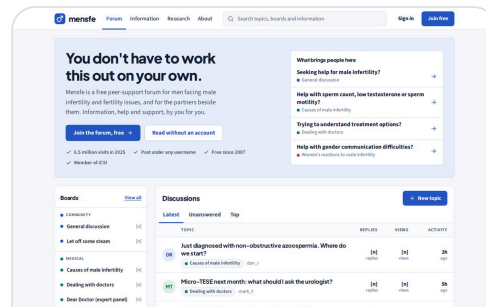
Each direction redesigns the same forum around the same content: a forum-first homepage, the board index, a topic page and a medical information page, all mobile-ready and built to fix the issues in the SEO audit.

Directions A–C present the forum through a modern website front; Direction D keeps the look and feel of a true message board. Please pick one direction (or the parts you like from each) and we will develop it into the full site and SMF theme.



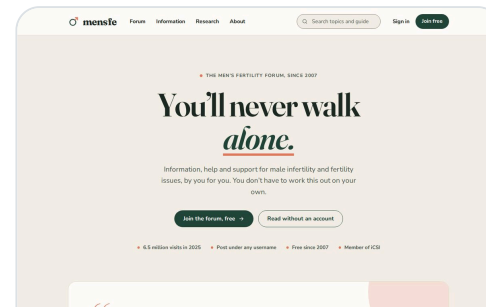
A • Harbour

Bold and branded. Confident, recognisable, a little dramatic.



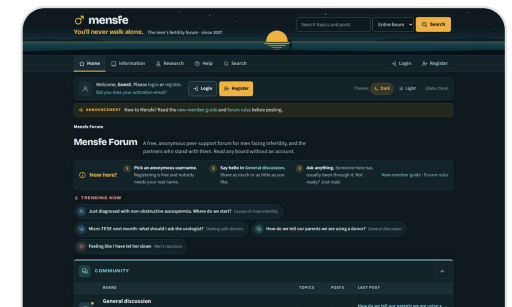
B • Clear

Clean and clinical. Feels like a modern health service crossed with a forum app.



C • Stories

Warm and human. Leads with members' voices, like a thoughtful magazine.

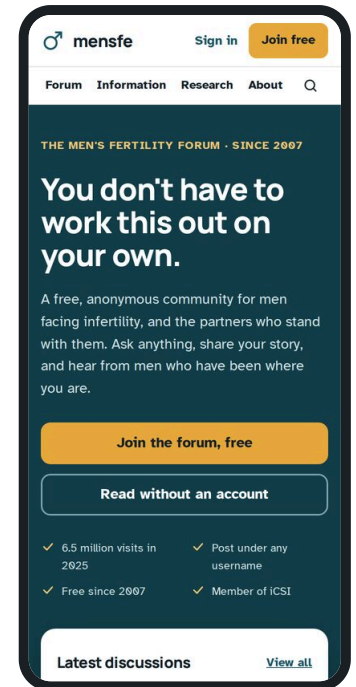
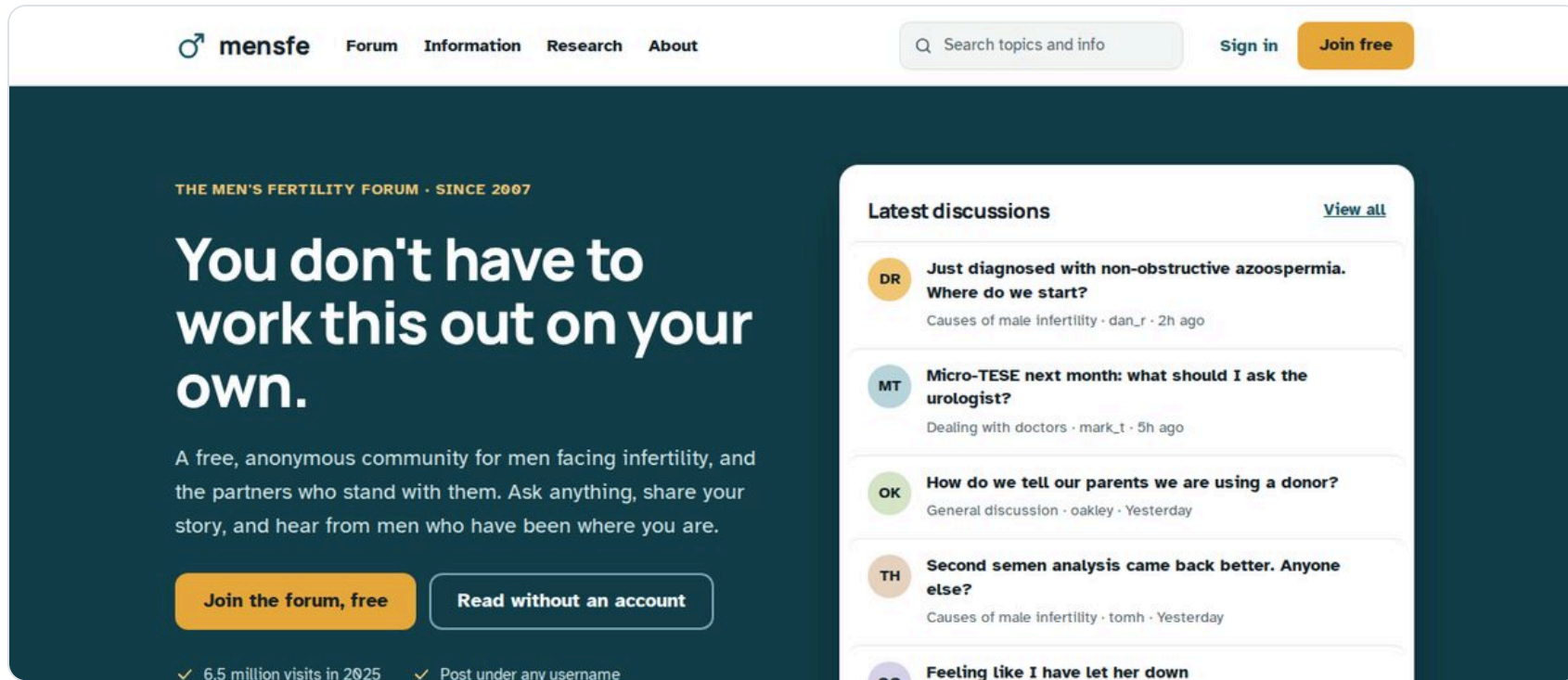


D • Forum

A true message board. Dark, distinctive and built around the board index.

All three share the same fixes: one clear heading per page, real text instead of text in images, latest discussions on the homepage, the founders' credentials on show, reviewer and date on medical pages, accessible contrast, and layouts that work on phones. Member counts appear as [n] placeholders, and sample posts are illustrative.

Harbour: bold and branded



Personality

- The deep sea-teal of the current shoreline banner, with a sunset-gold call to action
- A strong, memorable hero; the forum is visible from the first screen
- Best if Mensfe wants to look established and confident

Colour and type

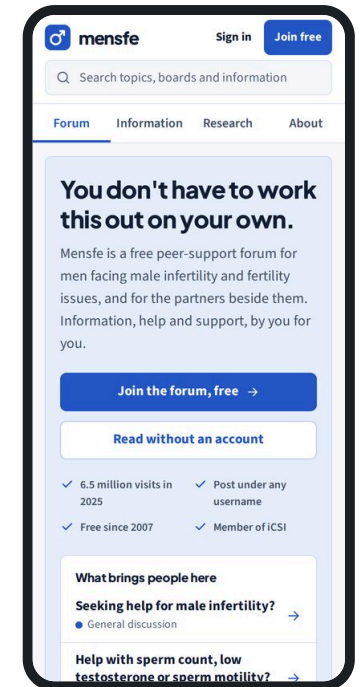
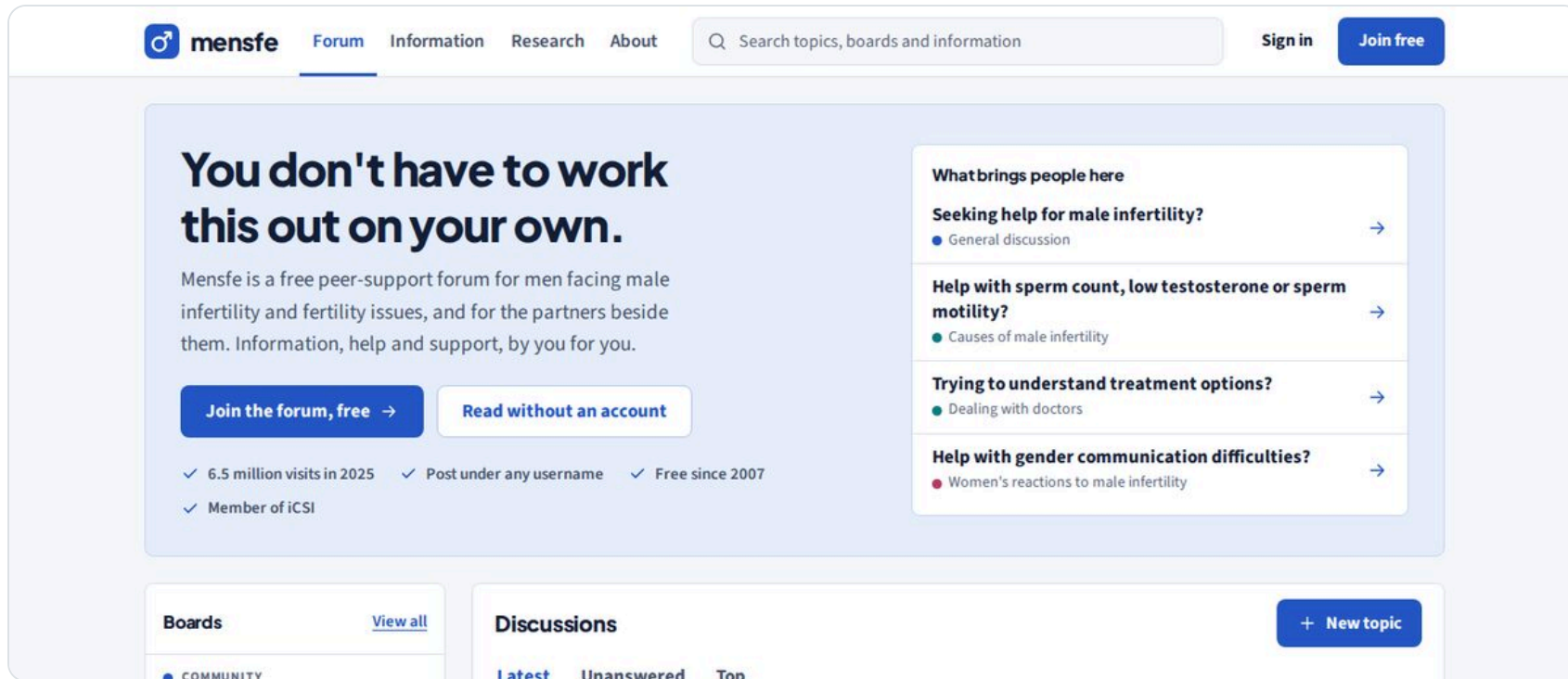


- Manrope headings, Atkinson Hyperlegible body text (designed for low-vision readability)

Watch-outs

- Dark bands are heavier on long pages
- Gold needs disciplined use to stay special

Clear: clean and clinical



Personality

- Calm, trustworthy and information-dense, like a modern health service
- A forum "app" layout: boards in a sidebar, a live topic feed with Latest, Unanswered and Top
- Best if Mensfe wants to feel medically credible and efficient

Colour and type

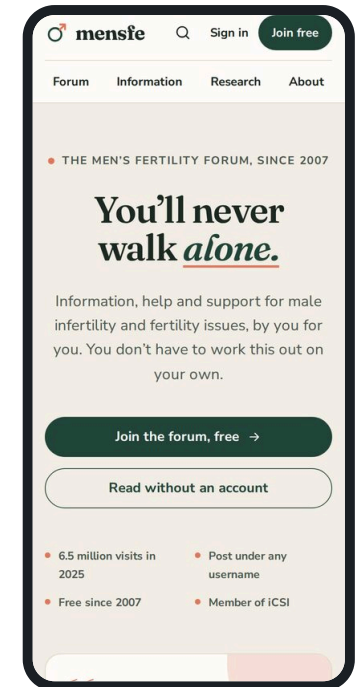
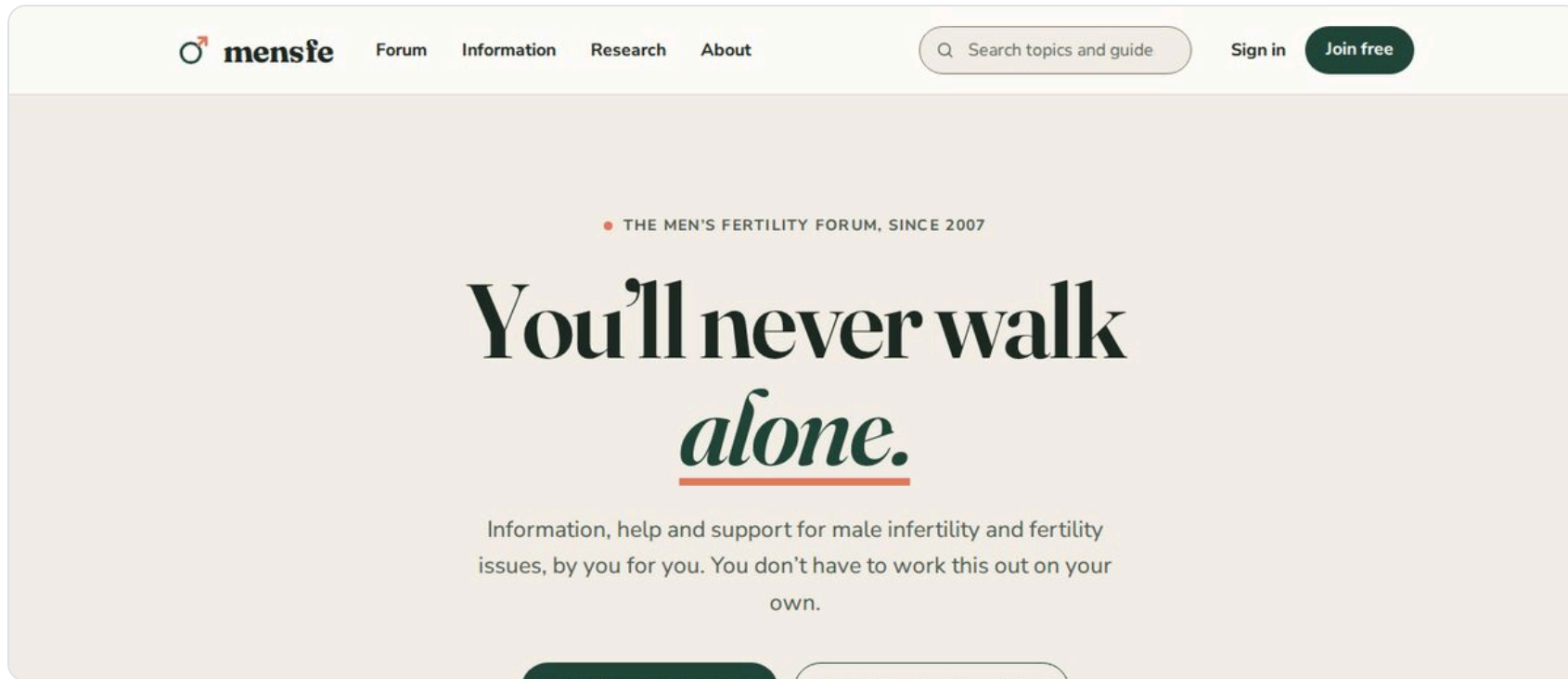


- Plus Jakarta Sans headings, Source Sans 3 body text

Watch-outs

- Can feel less personal; relies on activity in the feed
- Closest to SMF's own structure, so the easiest to theme

Stories: warm and human



Personality

- Editorial and reassuring; members' own words take centre stage
- Generous spacing and a serif voice for a reflective, magazine feel
- Best if Mensfe wants to emphasise empathy and the emotional side

Colour and type



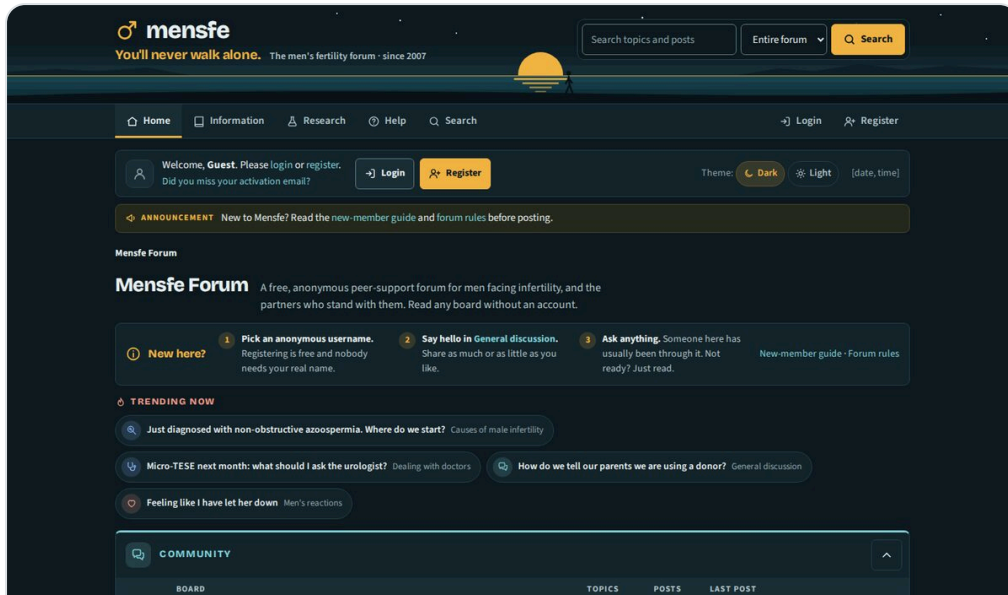
- Fraunces headings, Nunito Sans body text

Watch-outs

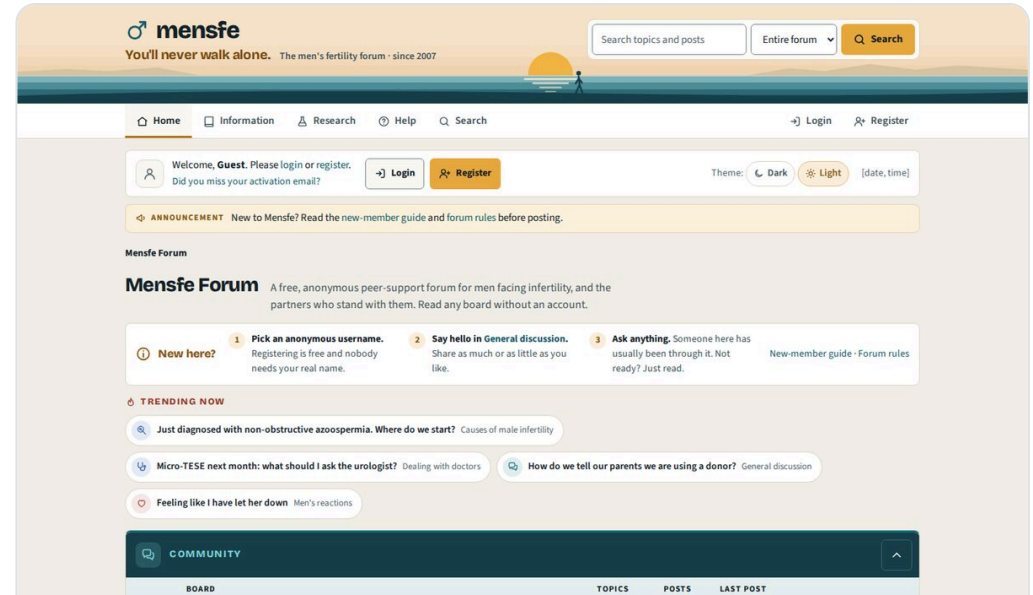
- Needs members' consent for featured stories
- Less dense, so more scrolling on busy boards

DIRECTION D

Forum: a true message board, reimagined



Dark · Midnight shoreline



Light · Daybreak shoreline

Personality

- The board index is the homepage, so regulars land straight in the forum
- Classic forum anatomy (category bars, last-post columns, profile panels beside posts, quick reply, info center) with a modern dark finish
- An illustrated night-shoreline banner revives "You'll never walk alone at Mensfe"

Colour and type



- Bricolage Grotesque headings, Source Sans 3 body text; each category has its own colour

Watch-outs

- Comes in dark and light; SMF can offer both as a member setting
- Closest to SMF's own templates, so it is the quickest to build

How the directions compare

	A · HARBOUR	B · CLEAR	C · STORIES	D · FORUM
First impression	Confident, branded	Professional, efficient	Warm, empathetic	Distinctive, community-first
Forum emphasis	Latest-discussions card in the hero; board grid	Live topic feed is the homepage	Featured member stories, then boards	The whole site is the forum; board index is home
Medical credibility	Good	Strongest	Good, more personal	Good (information section inside the forum)
Emotional warmth	Medium	Lower	Highest	Medium–high (members' voices up front)
Effort to theme SMF	Medium	Low	Medium–high	Lowest
Accessibility	Very high (hyperlegible body font)	High	High	High (contrast checked for dark mode)

What happens next: once a direction is chosen, we design the remaining pages (sign-up, profile, search, private messages and the 12 information guides), build the responsive SMF theme, and implement the SEO and AI visibility fixes from the audits during the same build.



Welcome, **Guest**. Please login or register.

Did you miss your activation email?

Login

Register

Theme:

Dark

Light

[date, time]

 **ANNOUNCEMENT** New to Mensfe? Read the new-member guide and forum rules before posting.

Mensfe Forum

Mensfe Forum

A free, anonymous peer-support forum for men facing infertility, and the partners who stand with them. Read any board without an account.

 New here?

1 **Pick an anonymous username.**
Registering is free and nobody needs your real name.

2 **Say hello in General discussion.**
Share as much or as little as you like.

3 **Ask anything.** Someone here has usually been through it. Not ready? Just read.

[New-member guide](#) · [Forum rules](#)

 TRENDING NOW



Just diagnosed with non-obstructive azoospermia. Where do we start? [Causes of male infertility](#)



Micro-TESE next month: what should I ask the urologist? [Dealing with doctors](#)



How do we tell our parents we are using a donor? [General discussion](#)



Feeling like I have let her down [Men's reactions](#)



COMMUNITY



BOARD

TOPICS

POSTS

LAST POST



General discussion

Anything and everything about male fertility.

Moderator: **Mensfe Team**

[n]

[n]

How do we tell our parents we are using a ...
by oakley · Yesterday



Let off some steam

Somewhere to vent when it all gets too much.

[n]

[n]

Another pregnancy announcement at work
by [username] · 3 days ago



Information guides

Plain-English guides to tests, causes and treatment, written for Mensfe members.

Redirects: [n]

Redirects to the Information section



MEDICAL



BOARD

TOPICS

POSTS

LAST POST



Causes of male infertility

Azoospermia, low count, varicocele, hormones and more.

Child boards: **Azoospermia** **Low count** **Varicocele** **Hormones**

Moderator: **Mensfe Team**

[n]

[n]

Just diagnosed with non-obstructive azoo...
by dan_r · 2h ago



Dealing with doctors

Appointments, clinics, tests and treatment.

[n]

[n]

Micro-TESE next month: what should I ask...
by mark_t · 5h ago



Dear Doctor (expert panel)

Questions answered by our medical panel.

Moderator: **Medical panel**

[n]

[n]

Does a varicocele affect sperm DNA?
by [username] · 4 days ago



FEELINGS AND RELATIONSHIPS



BOARD

TOPICS

POSTS

LAST POST



Men's reactions to infertility

How it feels, from the men living it.

[n]

[n]

Feeling like I have let her down
by quiet_one · 2 days ago



Women's reactions to male infertility

Partners share their side.

[n]

[n]

How do I support him without pushing?
by jo_partner · 3 days ago



RESEARCH



BOARD

TOPICS

POSTS

LAST POST



Current research on male infertility

New studies, trials and news.

[n]

[n]

Discussion thread: recent papers on sper...
by Mensfe Team · 5 days ago



New posts



No new posts



Redirect board



RECENT POSTS

View all

TOPIC

BOARD

STARTED BY

WHEN

Just diagnosed with non-obstructive azoospermia. Where do we start?

[Causes of male infertility](#)

[dan_r](#)

2h ago

Micro-TESE next month: what should I ask the urologist?

[Dealing with doctors](#)

[mark_t](#)

5h ago

How do we tell our parents we are using a donor?

[General discussion](#)

[oakley](#)

Yesterday

Second semen analysis came back better. Anyone else?

[Causes of male infertility](#)

[tomh](#)

Yesterday

Feeling like I have let her down

[Men's reactions to infertility](#)

[quiet_one](#)

2 days ago



INFO CENTER



Forum stats

6.5 million visits in 2025

[n] posts in [n] topics by [n] members.

Latest member: [username]

[View the most recent posts](#) · [More stats](#)

 Online now

DR MT OA TH QO JP

[n] guests, [n] members (most online today: [n])

Members: [dan_r](#), [mark_t](#), [oakley](#), [tomh](#), [quiet_one](#), [jo_partner](#)

Users active in the past 15 minutes.

 Who runs Mensfe

Founded by **Pip Reilly**, a professional fertility counsellor with over 15 years' experience with fertility charities, and **Rob Barlow**, a medical scientist diagnosed with azoospermia more than 25 years ago.

Pip's book: A Journey Through Male Infertility: Stronger Together.

Member of iCSI, International Consumer Support for Infertility.

Search topics and posts

Entire forum Search

Welcome, Guest. Please login or register. Did you miss your activation email?

Login Register

Theme: Dark Light [date, time]

ANNOUNCEMENT

New to Mensfe? Read the new-member guide and forum rules before posting.

Mensfe Forum

Mensfe Forum

A free, anonymous peer-support forum for men facing infertility, and the partners who stand with them. Read any board without an account.

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- Say hello in General discussion. Share as much or as little as you like.
- Ask anything. Someone here has usually been through it. Not ready? Just read.

New-member guide · Forum rules

TRENDING NOW

Just diagnosed with non-obstructive azoospermia. Where do we start? Causes of male infertility

Micro-TESE next month: what should I ask the urologist? Dealing with doctors

How do we tell our parents we are using a donor? General discussion

Feeling like I have let her down Men's reactions

COMMUNITY

General discussion

Anything and everything about male fertility.

Moderator: Mensfe Team

[n] topics · [n] posts

Last post: How do we tell our parents we are using a donor? by oakley · Yesterday

Let off some steam

Somewhere to vent when it all gets too much.

[n] topics · [n] posts

Last post: Another pregnancy announcement at work by [username] · 3 days ago

Information guides

Plain-English guides to tests, causes and treatment, written for Mensfe members.

Redirects: [n]

Redirects to the Information section

MEDICAL

Causes of male infertility

Azoospermia, low count, varicocele, hormones and more.

Child boards: Azoospermia Low count Varicocele Hormones

Moderator: Mensfe Team

[n] topics · [n] posts

Last post: Just diagnosed with non-obstructive azoospermia. Where do we start? by dan_r · 2h ago

Dealing with doctors

Appointments, clinics, tests and treatment.

[n] topics · [n] posts

Last post: Micro-TESE next month: what should I ask the urologist? by mark_t · 5h ago

Dear Doctor (expert panel)

Questions answered by our medical panel.

Moderator: Medical panel

[n] topics · [n] posts

Last post: Does a varicocele affect sperm DNA? by [username] · 4 days ago

FEELINGS AND RELATIONSHIPS

Men's reactions to infertility

How it feels, from the men living it.

[n] topics · [n] posts

Last post: Feeling like I have let her down by quiet_one · 2 days ago

Women's reactions to male infertility

Partners share their side.

[n] topics · [n] posts

Last post: How do I support him without pushing? by jo_partner · 3 days ago

RESEARCH

Current research on male infertility

New studies, trials and news.

[n] topics · [n] posts

Last post: Discussion thread: recent papers on sperm retrieval by Mensfe Team · 5 days ago

New posts No new posts

Redirect board

RECENT POSTS

Just diagnosed with non-obstructive azoospermia. Where do we start?

Board: Causes of male infertility · by dan_r · 2h ago

Micro-TESE next month: what should I ask the urologist?

Board: Dealing with doctors · by mark_t · 5h ago

How do we tell our parents we are using a donor?

Board: General discussion · by oakley · Yesterday

Second semen analysis came back better. Anyone else?

Board: Causes of male infertility · by tomh · Yesterday

Feeling like I have let her down

Board: Men's reactions to infertility · by quiet_one · 2 days ago

INFO CENTER

Forum stats

6.5 million visits in 2025

[n] posts in [n] topics by [n] members.

Latest member: [username]

View the most recent posts · More stats

Online now

[n] guests, [n] members (most online today: [n])

Members: dan_r, mark_t, oakley, tomh, quiet_one, jo_partner

Users active in the past 15 minutes.

Who runs Mensfe

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Pip's book: A Journey Through Male Infertility: Stronger Together.

Member of iCSI, International Consumer Support for Infertility.



Welcome, **Guest**. Please login or register.
Did you miss your activation email?

Login

Register

Theme:



Dark



Light

[date, time]

ANNOUNCEMENT New to Mensfe? Read the new-member guide and forum rules before posting.

Mensfe Forum > Medical > Causes of male infertility



Causes of male infertility

Azoospermia, low count, varicocele, hormones and more. Share test results, ask what they mean and compare notes with men who have had the same diagnosis.

Moderators: [Mensfe Team](#) · [Medical panel](#)



CHILD BOARDS



BOARD	TOPICS	POSTS	LAST POST
Azoospermia Obstructive and non-obstructive, sperm retrieval, next steps.	[n]	[n]	Just diagnosed with non-obstructive azoo... by dan_r · 2h ago
Low sperm count Count, motility and morphology, and what the numbers mean.	[n]	[n]	Second semen analysis came back better. ... by tomh · Yesterday
Varicocele Diagnosis, surgery and recovery.	[n]	[n]	Varicocele repair: did your numbers impro... by [username] · 2 days ago
Hormones and testosterone Low T, FSH, LH and hormone treatment.	[n]	[n]	Anyone tried clomiphene for low testoster... by [username] · 3 days ago

Pages:

1

2

3

...

[n]



+ New topic



Notify



Mark read



TOPICS

Sorted by last post

SUBJECT / STARTED BY	REPLIES / VIEWS	LAST POST
READ FIRST: Board guidelines and useful links Pinned Locked Started by Mensfe Team	[n] Replies [n] Views	READ FIRST: Board guidelines and useful l... by Mensfe Team · [date]
Azoospermia: frequently asked questions Pinned Started by Mensfe Team « 1 2 »	[n] Replies [n] Views	Azoospermia: frequently asked questions by mark_t · Yesterday
Just diagnosed with non-obstructive azoospermia. Where do we start? New Started by dan_r	[n] Replies [n] Views	Just diagnosed with non-obstructive azoo... by jo_partner · 2h ago
Second semen analysis came back better. Anyone else? Started by tomh	[n] Replies [n] Views	Second semen analysis came back better. ... by tomh · Yesterday
Karyotype normal, still waiting on Y-microdeletion results Started by sam_k	[n] Replies [n] Views	Karyotype normal, still waiting on Y-micro... by mark_t · Yesterday
High FSH and no sperm: what did your urologist suggest? Started by rich_w	[n] Replies [n] Views	High FSH and no sperm: what did your uro... by dan_r · 2 days ago
Varicocele repair: did your numbers improve? Hot Started by lee_b « 1 2 »	[n] Replies [n] Views	Varicocele repair: did your numbers impro... by [username] · 2 days ago
Obstructive after vasectomy: PESA or reversal? Started by pete_m	[n] Replies [n] Views	Obstructive after vasectomy: PESA or reve... by [username] · 3 days ago
Anyone tried clomiphene for low testosterone? Started by gaz77	[n] Replies [n] Views	Anyone tried clomiphene for low testoster... by [username] · 3 days ago
Low motility on two tests: what changes helped you? Started by andy_c	[n] Replies [n] Views	Low motility on two tests: what changes h... by tomh · 4 days ago
Klinefelter diagnosis in my thirties: where next? Started by [username]	[n] Replies [n] Views	Klinefelter diagnosis in my thirties: where ... by Mensfe Team · 5 days ago
Morphology at 1%: should we be worried? Started by nick_s	[n] Replies [n] Views	Morphology at 1%: should we be worried? by [username] · [date]

Pages:

1

2

3

...

[n]



+ New topic



Notify



Mark read



New posts



No new posts



Pinned

Pinned topic



Locked

Locked topic



Hot topic (many replies)

Jump to:

Causes of male infertility



Go

Users browsing this board: [n] guests



Welcome, **Guest**. Please login or register.
Did you miss your activation email?

Login

Register

Theme:

Dark

Light

[date, time]

ANNOUNCEMENT New to Mensfe? Read the new-member guide and forum rules before posting.

Mensfe Forum > Causes of male infertility > **Just diagnosed with non-obstructive azoospermia. Where do we start?**

Pages:

1

Reply

Notify

Mark unread

Print

AUTHOR

DR

dan_r

OP

Newbie

Posts: [n]

[location]

Joined: [date]

TOPIC · CAUSES OF MALE INFERTILITY

Just diagnosed with non-obstructive azoospermia. Where do we start?

Read [n] times · [n] replies · started by dan_r

Just diagnosed with non-obstructive azoospermia. Where do we start?

« on: [date, time] »

My wife and I got the results last week. Two semen analyses, both showed no sperm at all, and the consultant thinks it is probably non-obstructive. My FSH came back high.

I honestly don't know what to feel. I keep reading about micro-TESE and success rates and it is all a blur. If anyone has been through this, what should we be asking at the next appointment?

Helpful [n]

Support [n]

Same here [n]

Report to moderator

Logged

Re: Just diagnosed with non-obstructive azoospermia. Where do we start?

« Reply #1 on: [date, time] »

Quote from: dan_r on [date, time]

what should we be asking at the next appointment?

I was exactly where you are three years ago. Write your questions down before the appointment, because you will forget them in the room. Ask whether they have checked your karyotype and for Y-chromosome microdeletions, because that changed what our options were.

And look after yourself. The first month was the hardest part for me.

Helpful [n]

Support [n]

Same here [n]

Diagnosed 2023 · micro-TESE 2024 · one day at a time

Report to moderator

Logged

Re: Just diagnosed with non-obstructive azoospermia. Where do we start?

« Reply #2 on: [date, time] »

Welcome, and thank you for posting. A lot of men read this board without ever writing, so this will help others too. Our [Azoospermia guide](#) explains the tests and treatment terms you will hear, and the [Counselling Support page](#) lists services if you would like to talk to someone.

Helpful [n]

Support [n]

Same here [n]

Mensfe is peer support. It does not replace personal professional, legal or medical advice.

Report to moderator

Logged

Re: Just diagnosed with non-obstructive azoospermia. Where do we start?

« Reply #3 on: [date, time] »

Wife of a member here. It is not your fault, and she is probably as worried about you as about the result. Talking to each other helped us more than anything the clinic said.

Helpful [n]

Support [n]

Same here [n]

Partner of a Mensfe member · stronger together

Report to moderator

Logged

Pages:

1

Reply

Notify

Mark unread

Print

[← previous topic](#) [next topic →](#)

QUICK REPLY

With Quick-Reply you can write a post when viewing a topic without loading a new page. You can still use the normal reply and preview features.

Your reply

B

/

U

“

Share your experience or a kind word

☒ Notify me of replies

Preview

Post

Users browsing this topic: [n] guests

This is peer support, not medical advice. Members share their own experience. Please talk to your doctor, urologist or clinic about your own diagnosis and treatment. Read the forum rules.

 mensfe

Forum rules

Privacy

Terms

Contact

About

Patrons

[n] posts in [n] topics by [n] members · 6.5 million visits in 2025 · Latest member: [username]

Member of iCSI, International Consumer Support for Infertility · info@mensfe.net

Mensfe is peer support, not medical advice. It does not replace personal professional, legal or medical advice.

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INFORMATION

Male fertility

Infertility

Semen analysis

Azoospermia

Varicocele

Treatment

Vasectomy reversal

Erection problems

Egg donation

Sperm donation

Nutrition

Counselling support

Medical guide (jargon explained)

Emotive guide

ON THIS PAGE

1

What is azoospermia?

2

The two main types

3

How it is diagnosed

4

Treatment options

5

Discuss this on the forum

6

Sources

INFORMATION GUIDE · CAUSES OF MALE INFERTILITY

Azoospermia

What it means when a semen analysis finds no sperm, the two main types, the tests you are likely to have and the routes to parenthood that are open to you.

 Written by [Author name]

 Medically reviewed by [Reviewer name, credentials]

 Last reviewed [date]

Mensfe is run by **Pip Reilly**, a professional fertility counsellor with over 15 years' experience with fertility charities, and **Rob Barlow**, a medical scientist who was diagnosed with azoospermia more than 25 years ago.

IN SHORT

- Azoospermia means no measurable sperm in the ejaculate. It affects about 1% of all men and around 10–15% of men with infertility.
- It is either **obstructive** (sperm are made but blocked) or **non-obstructive** (the testes make very little or no sperm).
- Many men can still become fathers, through surgery, sperm retrieval with ICSI, or donor sperm.

What is azoospermia?

Azoospermia means there is no measurable sperm in the ejaculate. It affects about 1% of all men and around 10–15% of men with infertility.

It is usually confirmed by at least two semen analyses, with the sample spun down (centrifuged) so the laboratory can look for any sperm at all.

The two main types

OBSTRUCTIVE

Sperm are made, but blocked

A blockage stops sperm reaching the ejaculate. This can happen after a vasectomy, an infection or an injury, or because of congenital absence of the vas deferens, which is linked to cystic fibrosis gene changes.

NON-OBSTRUCTIVE

Very little or no sperm is made

The testes make very little or no sperm. Causes include genetic conditions such as Klinefelter syndrome or Y-chromosome microdeletions, hormone problems, a history of undescended testes, or previous chemotherapy or radiotherapy.

How it is diagnosed

- Repeat semen analysis**, with the sample centrifuged to look for any sperm.
- Physical examination** by a urologist or andrologist.
- Hormone blood tests**: FSH, LH and testosterone.
- Genetic tests**: karyotype, Y-chromosome microdeletion and CFTR (the cystic fibrosis gene).
- Sometimes a **scrotal ultrasound**.

Treatment options

Obstructive azoospermia

Surgical repair, such as vasectomy reversal, or sperm retrieval (PESA, MESA or TESA) with the sperm then used in ICSI.

Non-obstructive azoospermia

In some men, hormone treatment. Surgical sperm retrieval, such as micro-TESE, with any sperm found used in ICSI.

Donor sperm

Donor sperm is another route to parenthood. Many couples consider it alongside, or after, other options.

Talk your options through with a urologist or andrologist, who can explain what fits your test results.



DISCUSS THIS ON THE FORUM

From Causes of male infertility · [n] members discussing

SUBJECT / STARTED BY	REPLIES / VIEWS	LAST POST
  Just diagnosed with non-obstructive azoospermia. Where do we start? Started by dan_r	[n] Replies [n] Views	Just diagnosed with non-obstructive azoo... by jo_partner · 2h ago
 High FSH and no sperm: what did your urologist suggest? Started by rich_w	[n] Replies [n] Views	High FSH and no sperm: what did your uro... by dan_r · 2 days ago
  Karyotype normal, still waiting on Y-microdeletion results Started by sam_k	[n] Replies [n] Views	Karyotype normal, still waiting on Y-micro... by mark_t · Yesterday

You are not alone. Men who have had this diagnosis answer questions here every day.

View the board

Ask the community: start a topic

Sources

- [Source 1, e.g. NHS / NICE / WHO guidance]
- [Source 2, e.g. clinical guideline on male infertility]
- [Source 3, e.g. peer-reviewed review article]

Was this page helpful?

Yes

No



Mensfe is peer support. It does not replace personal professional, legal or medical advice. Please talk to your own doctor about your diagnosis and treatment.